

Krishna Kumar Kannan

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SUMMARY

Emerging Food Science Professional with 3+ years of hands-on experience in product development and quality assurance since graduating in 2020. Expertise in spray drying, GMP implementation, and innovative food product creation. Successfully co-founded Merakis Myco Labs, developing mushroom-based products from concept to market while gaining practical experience in manufacturing operations. Demonstrated ability to lead research projects, conduct sensory evaluations, and implement natural preservation techniques. Transitioning from teaching and student mentoring to pursue growth opportunities in food manufacturing and product development.

EXPERIENCE

SRI SHAKTHI INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY | COIMBATORE, INDIA | MARCH 2024 - MAY 2025

- Maintained student engagement through creative subject delivery and learning activities.
- Built inclusive frameworks supporting individualized student development.
- Assisted in developing departmental policies, procedures, and activities related to educational programs.
- Mentored and assisted with student-centered activities on campus to establish professional relationships.
- Organized laboratory operations.

MERAKIS MYCO LAB LLP | COIMBATORE, INDIA | OCTOBER 2022 - APRIL 2023

- Successfully established Merakis Myco Labs LLP, leading the development of mushroom-based food products (chocolate, jerky, tincture, value-added products).
- Managed all aspects of mushroom production, ensuring quality and sustainability.
- Implemented techniques in gourmet mushroom cultivation, strain culture and bio-composite development.
- Learned product conceptualization, development, market analysis and commercialization strategies.

PROJECT M | COIMBATORE, INDIA | January 2021 - JULY 2022

- Tackled challenges in maintaining optimal cultivation parameters.
- Applied advanced problem-solving skills to enhance efficiency and cost savings. Collaborated closely with cross-functional teams to drive continuous improvement.
- Demonstrated exceptional adaptability and resilience, delivering successful outcomes ahead of schedule and under budget.

MEGA FOODS Pvt. Ltd | CHENNAI, INDIA | MARCH 2019 - MAY 2019

- Supervised product storage to ensure adherence to optimal conditions for quality preservation.
- Managed receiving and storage of raw materials, implementing efficient inventory management practices to enhance production efficiency.

SKILLS

- Spray Drying
- Freeze Drying
- Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP)
- Documentation
- New Product Development
- Quality Control (QC)
- Curriculum and Course Development
- Project Management

EDUCATION

- **SRM INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY | CHENNAI, INDIA.**
M.Tech – Food and Nutritional Biotechnology | MAY 2020
- **SRM INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY | CHENNAI, INDIA.**
B.Tech - Biotechnology | MAY 2018

CERTIFICATIONS

- NPD BASICS
- FSSC 22000 VERSION 6

PROJECTS

- **Development of spray-dried amla milkshake powder | 01/06/2019 - 31/05/2020**
 - Developed spray-dried amla powder and milkshake powder using innovative spray-drying techniques.
 - Conducted sensory evaluations and chemical analyses to assess product quality and shelf stability.
 - Published research findings in *the Journal of Emerging Technologies and Innovative Research*.
- **Isolation of Thermophilic Bacteria from Compost Pit | 03/01/2018 - 22/05/2018**
 - Isolated thermophilic bacteria from compost pits and identified enzymes with industrial potential
 - Investigated bacterial growth kinetics and metabolic capabilities under various conditions.
 - Explored applications of thermostable enzymes in industrial processes.
- **Development of Mushroom Jerky using *Pleurotus ostreatus* and *Agaricus bisporus* | 17/11/2022 -10/02/2023**
 - Created innovative dual-species mushroom jerky combining distinctive properties of Oyster and Button mushrooms.
 - Developed process to utilize all mushroom parts, reducing waste.
 - Received positive feedback in consumer testing.
- **Study of Synergistic Antimicrobial Effects in Preservative-Free Fruit Juice Systems Using Natural Acidulants and Thermal Processing | 04/06/2024 - 28/12/2024**
 - Studied natural preservation methods for fruit juices without artificial additives.
 - Tested various acidulant combinations to determine optimal antimicrobial effectiveness.
 - Analyzed microbial reduction rates at different processing temperatures.